IELTS Turbo · Week 13 · Wednesday · Listening and Reading

Academic verbs and signposts (exam day)

1. Read the article once for meaning. 2. Read it again and look at the **highlighted new words** and the **blue phrases** in context. 3. Study the tables. 4. Use at least 5 new words in speaking or writing this week.

Article: Reading like an academic: the language of argument (177 words)

Academic writers rarely state facts without comment. They **indicate** a trend, **suggest** a link, or **claim** that something is true, and then **argue** for their position. A careful author will **acknowledge** the limits of the evidence and **emphasize** what remains uncertain. A study may **reveal** a surprising pattern, **establish** a clear cause, or on the contrary **undermine** a popular theory.

Readers must notice how ideas are connected. **However**, **nevertheless** and **whereas** signal a contrast, **furthermore** adds a similar point, and **consequently** shows a result. When a writer says that researchers **assume** something, that is not the same as proof. Words such as **considerable**, **significant** and **approximately** control the strength and precision of a statement: a **significant** difference is not the same as a tiny one, and a result of **approximately** half is not exactly half.

Good readers **read between the lines** and **weigh up** the evidence before they decide. Remember also that many factors **contribute** to any outcome and **contrast** with a single cause. Practice noticing these signals, and True / False / Not Given questions become far easier.

Useful phrases from the article

Phrase	Meaning
read between the lines	understand what is not said openly
weigh up	compare

The 20 new words

Word		Meaning	Example
indicate	v	to show or point to	*The graph indicates a steady rise.*
suggest	v	to put forward an idea	*The study suggests a link.*
claim	v	to say something is true	*Some experts claim the method works.*
argue	v	to give reasons for or against	*The author argues for change.*
reveal	v	to make known	*The results revealed a pattern.*
establish	v	to prove or set up	*The research established a clear cause.*
assume	v	to accept as true without proof	*Researchers assumed the data was accurate.*
emphasize	v	to give special importance	*The writer emphasizes the risks.*

contrast	v	to compare differences	*The article contrasts two methods.*
acknowledge	v	to accept that something is true	*The author acknowledges the limits.*
undermine	v	to weaken	*New data undermined the theory.*
contribute	v	to help cause something	*Poor diet contributes to illness.*
considerable	adj	large in amount	*There was a considerable increase.*
significant	adj	important or large enough to notice	*A significant number agreed.*
approximately	adv	about	*Approximately half agreed.*
however	adv	used to show contrast	*However, results varied.*
consequently	adv	as a result	*Consequently, sales fell.*
furthermore	adv	in addition	*Furthermore, costs rose.*
nevertheless	adv	in spite of that	*Nevertheless, the plan continued.*
whereas	conj	used to compare two facts	*The north is dry, whereas the south is wet.*

Revision: 10 words from last week

Word		Meaning
agriculture	n	the science and practice of farming
crop	n	a plant grown for food
harvest	n	the gathering of ripe crops
livestock	n	animals kept on a farm
fertilizer	n	a substance added to soil to help plants grow
irrigation	n	supplying land with water
organic	adj	grown without chemicals
genetically modified	adj	changed by altering genes
famine	n	a severe shortage of food
nutrient	n	a substance needed for growth

Practice: fill the gaps

furthermore · claim · however · nevertheless · contrast · indicate · contribute · argue

1. _____, costs rose.
2. Some experts _____ the method works.

3. _____, results varied.
4. _____, the plan continued.
5. The article _____ two methods.
6. The graph _____ a steady rise.
7. Poor diet _____ to illness.
8. The author _____ for change.

More words on this topic (not in the article: choose the 10 most useful for you)

albeit (conj): although
allocate (v): to give for a purpose
alternative (adj): different from the usual
analyze (v): to examine in detail
anticipate (v): to expect
attribute (v): to say something is caused by
coincide (v): to happen at the same time
compile (v): to collect and put together
concede (v): to admit
conclude (v): to decide after thought
conduct (v): to carry out
correspond (v): to match
demonstrate (v): to show clearly
derive (v): to come from
distinguish (v): to see the difference
elaborate (v): to give more detail
estimate (v): to calculate roughly
evaluate (v): to judge the value
exceed (v): to go beyond
imply (v): to suggest without saying
infer (v): to work out from evidence
interpret (v): to explain the meaning
justify (v): to show as reasonable
maintain (v): to continue to say
obtain (v): to get
predominantly (adv): mainly
refute (v): to prove wrong
substantially (adv): to a large degree
whereby (adv): by which

Answers

1. Furthermore (furthermore)
2. claim (claim)
3. However (however)
4. Nevertheless (nevertheless)
5. contrasts (contrast)
6. indicates (indicate)
7. contributes (contribute)
8. argues (argue)